

wirelessly) which does consume a bit of power. This brings the NFC pretty close to Bluetooth 4.0 VL in terms of energy efficiency.

There is no pairing code in this scenario as is present in Bluetooth, so security concerns regarding what data should be present on an NFC chip have been raised. Across the world there are pilot programmes being conducted to test the feasibility of this new technology. As for India, there hasn't been anything so far, basically due to poor penetration of the technology, so NFC is mostly used here for contact swapping. The applications are pretty diverse, we now have mobile phones acting as wallets which can be used at shopping malls, to pay public transport ticket fares, utilise parking meters, etc. Then we have interactive advertising posters which can import your details to present you with customised offers and so on. The primary application scenario is to eliminate plastic credit/debit cards which as we all know is pretty sensitive to magnets and scratches on the magnetic strip can wreck havoc.

GPS

GPS is one of the many global navigation systems based on satellites in space. It is used to pinpoint your current position accurately within a few meters. There are applications to help you navigate from one place to another; then there are applications which track your locations and the places you visit to generate social profiles, etc.

GPS requires that your device to establish communication with at least three satellites for a geographical location and a further 4th for altitude and error correction. It's quite a handy feature for tourists to navigate foreign countries and locations outside terrestrial transmission equipment's coverage.

SIM sizes

With the ever increasing drive to shrink things even the SIM card had to undergo shrinkage. We now have three variants -

- ▶ Mini-SIM
- ▶ Micro-SIM
- ▶ Nano-SIM

This does not mean that you'd have to get a new SIM when you buy your next mobile or tablet. There are special mechanical punch machines which can convert your Mini-SIM to a

